

SHAY HALL

Product Design & UX Leader

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Product and UX design leader with 10+ years of experience spanning design leadership, product strategy, UX research, and front-end engineering. Currently leads a multidisciplinary team of 12 and has built four design organizations from the ground up through enterprise software acquisitions and strategic initiatives. Skilled at embedding design into product strategy, Agile delivery, and executive decision-making, and at developing high-performing teams that turn complex technology into clear, valuable customer experiences. Led design for major launches across networking, observability, SaaS, automation, and AI, including cutting onboarding time from roughly three months to 30 minutes. Known for connecting design, technology, and business strategy to make design a genuine partner to Product and Engineering.

CORE SKILLS

Design & Organizational Leadership: Design Leadership, Design Management, Organizational Design, Design Maturity, Team Building, Talent Development, Design Operations, Change Management, Executive Leadership

Product & UX Strategy: Product Strategy, UX Strategy, Product Discovery, Design Strategy, Customer Experience Strategy, Innovation Strategy, User Research, Research Strategy, Design Systems

Cross-Functional & Delivery: Product Management Partnership, Engineering Partnership, Agile Transformation, Cross-Functional Leadership, Strategic Planning, Resource Planning, Accessibility, Design Thinking

Technology & Domains: Enterprise SaaS, B2B Software, AI Product Design, Enterprise Software, Complex Systems, Networking, Observability, Automation, Design Engineering

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IBM — Durham, NC

2021 – Present

Senior Design Manager

- Lead a multidisciplinary design organization of 12 direct reports — 8 UX designers, 3 researchers, and 1 visual designer — owning hiring, performance management, career development, staffing, and resource allocation across enterprise software products.
- Built four design organizations from the ground up through acquisitions and strategic initiatives, establishing operating models, hiring and developing talent, and integrating UX, research, visual design, and content design into Product and Engineering.
- Transformed the NS1 and SevOne design practices after acquisition: grew NS1 from one junior designer to a 10-person multidisciplinary team, and SevOne from zero designers to a 13-person design and research organization supporting nine development squads through a flexible shared-team model.
- Redesigned Concert Network Observability onboarding, cutting time from initial onboarding to productive customer use from roughly three months to 30 minutes and accelerating time-to-value.
- Led design for major products and integrations spanning networking, observability, SaaS, automation, and AI, including Cloud Sync, Zero Trust Connect, Concert Network Observability, Synthetics, Saige AI, watsonX Orchestrate, and BAMOE.
- Integrated design into acquired product organizations by establishing UX research, prioritization, and Agile practices; migrated SevOne and NS1 experiences to IBM Carbon and advanced WCAG AA accessibility.
- Led the Jumpstart Innovation Team, a lean five-person design group, partnering with VP-level Product and Design leadership on strategy and scope while overseeing four to five incubation projects annually; led design strategy and the main-stage THINK presentation for the initial launch of watsonX Orchestrate.
- Shaped Databand/Instana product strategy by advocating for a co-selling approach over a costly technical integration — work the lead Product Manager credited with saving both organizations significant time and money.
- Introduced AI-enabled design workflows for domain upskilling, research synthesis, meeting and decision summaries, low-fidelity ideation, coded prototyping, heuristic audits, and requirements validation.

- Mentored 40+ designers, conducted 75+ hiring interviews, onboarded 25+ designers, supported five acquisitions, and presented product and design strategy to the CEO, 12+ VPs/SVPs, and General Managers.

IBM — *Durham, NC*

2020 – 2021

UX Designer & Design Lead

- Promoted into a hands-on design leadership role shaping end-to-end user experiences, project strategy, storytelling, research, coaching, and cross-functional delivery.
- Filed two patents, published an article on improv and design thinking, and received two Outstanding Technical Achievement Awards plus the Big Business Innovation Award.
- Led and contributed to product design across IBM Multichannel Management, CloudPak for Automation, Transformation Advisor, Mono2Micro, and Watson Orchestrate; taught the Design Thinking Masterclass at AppMod Tech Con.

IBM — *Durham, NC*

2016 – 2020

Front End Developer / UX Engineer

- Built performant, scalable UI solutions using JavaScript, HTML, CSS, and component-driven interfaces; converted prototypes to production code and built coded prototypes for user testing.
- Founded and co-led the FED@IBM RTP Branch; received the Manager's Choice Award and RockIT Distinguished Mentor Award; facilitated Design Thinking workshops for students, customers, marketing teams, NASCAR representatives, and City of Durham stakeholders.

Vishay Precision Group — *Wendell, NC*

2016

Web Developer

- Architected a complex modular product-filtering experience and dynamic product results and details pages, partnering across product groups and integrating AngularJS templates into Drupal.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Measurement, Inc. — Test Creation Specialist (2016) | Queenfin LLC — Web Developer, Contract (2016) | Various United Methodist Churches — Founding Pastor, Senior Pastor & Youth Pastor (2007–2015)

TEACHING & EDUCATION

Guest Lecturer & Facilitator, Duke University Master of Engineering Management — 2018–Present

M.Div., Duke University Divinity School — 2007 | B.A., Film Studies, UNC Wilmington — 2003 (Minor: Religion & Creative Writing)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Design Engineering, HTML/CSS, JavaScript, Carbon Design System, Git/GitHub, Jira, Agile, Scrum, Prototyping